

ALERT ID	SOURCE SYSTEM	ALERT TIME	ANALYST
CLD-010010	Microsoft Entra ID / Watchlist IP Activity	2026-09-01 05:09 – 05:11 UTC	Eshak Basta

ALERT (WHAT FIRED, ON WHOM OR WHAT):

- The scheduled analytic rule, "Watchlist IP activity," fired after three sign-in attempts targeting `daniel.reeve@cloudora.io` were detected between 05:09 and 05:11 UTC from `102.89.44.17` in Lagos, Nigeria. All three authentication attempts returned error 53003 and were blocked by Conditional Access. The source IP was already present on the tenant block list and had previously been identified as attacker infrastructure during incident CLD-0001.

HYPOTHESIS (BOTH DIRECTIONS):

- Malicious: A known threat actor attempted to authenticate using previously identified attacker infrastructure.
- Benign: A previously blocked indicator triggered the analytic rule while security controls successfully prevented access.

EVIDENCE CHECKED:

- Reviewed the alert details and `cloudora_signin_slice.csv`.
- Confirmed three sign-in attempts from `102.89.44.17` between 05:09 and 05:11 UTC.
- Confirmed all three attempts returned error 53003, meaning Conditional Access blocked the requests.
- Confirmed the source IP was already on the tenant block list.
- Cross-referenced the IP with CLD-0001, where it had previously been identified as attacker infrastructure.
- No successful authentication from the source IP was identified.

VERDICT:

True positive	False positive	Duplicate	Escalate	Insufficient data
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SEVERITY:

- Sev 4 – Confirmed malicious activity with minimal impact.
- The sign-in attempts originated from known attacker infrastructure and represented legitimate malicious activity. However, all three authentication attempts were blocked by Conditional Access, preventing unauthorized access and limiting the impact to the targeted account.

ACTION:

- Monitor the account and known attacker infrastructure. Maintain the existing Conditional Access block and re-escalate if activity from the same infrastructure produces any result other than 53003 or begins targeting additional accounts. The course answer key specifically recommends a written re-raise condition rather than simply ignoring the activity.

JUSTIFICATION:

- Three endpoints across separate offices established repeated HTTPS connections to the same newly registered, uncategorized destination at approximately 60-second intervals, while KQL analysis showed no corresponding abnormal successful sign-ins or suspicious account changes, indicating likely endpoint compromise rather than cloud-account takeover.

MITRE ATT&CK:

- T1110.003 – Password Spraying, attempted.

